'Round the Mountainside

Quarterly newsletter for Coolfont Mountainside Association
Volume XLIV, Issue 1

Winter 2019

Coolfont Resort – It's Happening Soon!

By Liz Dane and Dawne Holz

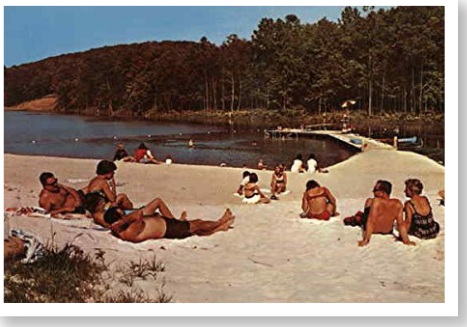


Closed since 2006, the Coolfont Resort is about to have a grand re-opening! Larry Omps confirmed he will be opening all of the resort in April or May. He passed along details of the construction progress.

Treetop House, the large A-frame building, has been completely renovated in an "upscale lodge" decor. Inside, the former Treetop Restaurant will be all new with a complete bar (ABC license pending) and a new name. They will serve a limited menu at first, but will expand to a full menu when fully operational. They'll feature Berkeley Springs Brewing Company beverages as well as those from other breweries in the area (see article about BSBC on page 5).



Workers have finished renovations of the Woodland House Lodge, across Cold Run Valley Road from the main building. The original 24 units were converted to 12 suites, each with two bedrooms. The indoor pool and spa building - located behind the old tennis courts - is very close to completion. The spa and new exercise facility are done and they expect to fill the saltwater pool in March.



Out at the lake, there will be a contracted concessionaire to operate the lake activities. Boat rentals will be available as well as fishing and guided fishing tours in the area. Coolfont Resort intends to offer memberships to CMA members only, though no additional information is available at this time. We will pass along details about Resort membership as soon as it is available.

Watch for updates via the CMA listserv (Google group).
Photos are of previous Resort operations.

Upcoming Events

Board of Directors Meeting	March 16, 2019, 10:00 am	CMA Office
Pot Luck Dinner	March 16, 2019, 6:30 pm	Needs a host! See page 3.
Board of Directors Meeting	April 13, 2019, 10:00 am	CMA Office
Pot Luck Dinner	April 13, 2019, 6:30 pm	Needs a host! See page 3.

Septic Maintenance Program

By Holly Malcomb, Site Manager

Are you Septic Savvy? Do you know where your septic tanks are located? When was your system last serviced?

Here's some information you should know:

Each CMA home is supposed to have dual septic tanks that manage sewage solids. The liquid, or effluent, flows through our sewer system to our lagoon, where it is treated and released into Sir Johns Run. This is a fragile system and operates under very strict EPA guidelines.

In our forested environment, septic tanks and connected lines can be impacted by tree and shrub roots, overall age, ground shift and neglect. Therefore, it's important that every homeowner service their septic system regularly. Septic systems that are not functioning properly or are damaged can harm our sewer system - or worse - they can leech sewage into the soil and potentially impact our water supply.

It is each homeowner's responsibility to have their septic system pumped and inspected at regular intervals - at the homeowner's expense. To protect our sewer system, the Association has started maintaining records of septic tank locations and service for each home.

Please send a copy of your last septic inspection and service to the Site Manager by June 1, 2019.

To help with this effort, please send a copy of your last septic inspection and service to the Site Manager. Please include a simple drawing of where your tanks are located on your property.

These records will be reviewed to ensure all homes meet the required service schedule. Please send this information by June 1, 2019.

The Site Managers will contact owners whose homes require inspection or service. If service is not completed by the date requested, the Association may arrange for inspection and pumping with the cost billed to the owner.

Septic Inspection & Service Schedule

Full-time residents:
Every 5 years

Rental properties:
Every 5 years

Part-time residents:
Every 10 years

Suggested contractors:
Beddows Septic: 304-671-1773
Glens Septic: 301-678-5233

If you need to service your septic system, you can use your choice of contractor. We have included contact information for two local companies, but the CMA does not endorse or recommend these over any other contractor.

If you have any questions or need assistance, please contact our Site Managers, Holly Malcomb or Jason Schetrompf, at 304-671-0882/304-676-3993 or almostheavenpm1@gmail.com.

Were you furloughed?
If you were affected by the government shutdown and need more time to pay, please contact Brenda Close.

2019 Assessments

Annual assessment payments were due January 31.

If you've already paid, thanks!

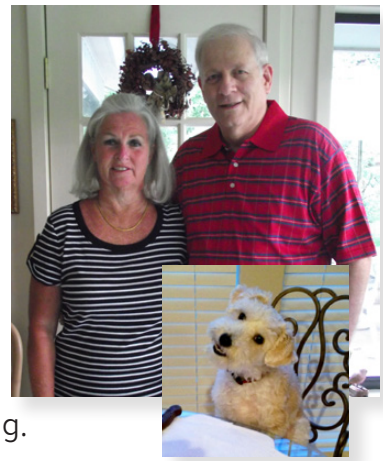
If not, please send payment immediately to avoid late fees and interest.

Questions? Please contact our bookkeeper, Brenda Close, at 304-258-4742 or brendac@closecpa.com.

Our New Neighbors

By our new neighbors

Katz, K-1



This year, we welcomed Kathy and Steve Katz who purchased the property at 55 Bobcat Trail in April. They're full-time residents on the mountain. Kathy is retired and joined by their dog, Kady, at home while Steve is still working.

Neuman, M-5



Robert (Bob) Neuman is a full-time resident living in Green Gables at 95 Dogwood Lane. He purchased the property in May and is enjoying Coolfont very much. Bob is already involved, volunteering with the Neighborhood Watch Patrol which has also helped acquaint him with the area. He has varied interests which include film (and has done some acting) and traveling. His recent trips include Amelia Island in Florida and Nova Scotia.

Rezmovic, R-8



Evi and Victor Rezmovic are two happy retirees, living most of the time in Potomac, MD, and part-time at 50 Bobcat Way, aka Far Foodle. They thoroughly enjoy their new home and the CMA members they've met. Evi and Victor have two children and four grandchildren in the DC area who also love coming to Far Foodle. After careers in policy research (Evi) and IT (Victor), Far Foodle affords them the perfect place to decompress, explore and experience new things. They keep busy with family, travel, the gym, going to the theater, reading and volunteering. Retirement is proving to be a very busy time!

Host a CMA Pot Luck!

the potluck club

Reserve your date to host a Pot Luck dinner!

Available Dates
Mar 16, Apr 13, May 18
Aug 3, Nov 9, Dec 14

Email your hosting date to:
rosemary@mygrandmotherslace.com

Young, E-1

In December, Gail and Jeff Young bought the house at 170 Whipoorwill Way. They are residents of Gettysburg, PA. Gail recently retired from nursing after 38 years! She's now busy being a grandmom and loves it! Jeff is still working full time. They have three grandsons and another on the way. They enjoy golfing, although Gail says her spirit is stronger than her game. They love to run the roads and explore antique shops in the area and look forward to golfing, relaxing and new adventures in Coolfont!

Other Recent Additions

Georgia and Robert Lowman, Q-2, are permanent residents. They purchased the house at 451 Bobcat Drive.

Michelle and Michael Siri, Q-5, bought the property at 346 Bobcat Drive in 2016. Their permanent residence is in Cockeysville, MD.

Correction:

On page 3 of the Fall 2018 issue, we reported "Joan Claybrook and Cathy Van Metre were reelected to the board." This should have been "Joan Claybrook and **Cindy Van Meter** were reelected to the board." We apologize for the error.



Remember this?
Found in the CMA archives!

WSPSD Now on Tap

By Cathy Levey

As of January 15, 2019, Warm Springs Public Service District (WSPSD) is managing the CMA water system. Their responsibilities include daily water testing, water treatment, general oversight, alarm response, maintenance and repairs. You will see WSPSD staff onsite daily, including Terrance Cross, the chief operator, Andy McKenzie and Monty Cerns.

Residents can contact WSPSD directly about water system issues. When calling, please state your name, address, lot number and the nature of the problem.

Weekdays, 9:00 am to 5:00 pm: 304-258-4118

All other times (weekends, holidays, after hours), Morgan County non-emergency: 304-258-0305

CLIP & SAVE

Water Issues? Call:

Warm Springs Public Service District

Weekdays, 9:00 am to 5:00 pm:
304-258-4118

All other times Morgan County
non-emergency: 304-258-0305

Provide your name, address, lot number and the nature of the problem.

Board Notes

December 8, 2018 Meeting

- Minutes of November 10, 2018 Board meeting were approved
- Jackson Bain provided an update on the MR² Report and the sewer project with Larry Omps
- A motion was approved to proceed with the road and culvert work
- President Hughes recommended formation of a committee to prepare information on water rates for the Public Service Commission
- Board meeting dates for 2019 were set as: January 12, March 16, April 13, May 11, June 29, August 3, November 9 and December 14
- The Annual Meeting was scheduled for September 21

January 12, 2019 Meeting

- Officers were elected for a one-year term (see the list at “Board of Directors” on page 8)
- Minutes of the December 8, 2018 Board meeting were approved with noted edits
- President Hughes explained the Association would need to find a new person to oversee the sewer system (from homes to lagoon)
- Cathy Levey reported WSPSD had taken over water system management
- Holly Malcomb reported work will start in late January on cleaning out drainage ditches and road repairs, weather permitting
- Social committee is soliciting volunteers for the 2019 pot luck dinners
- Holly Malcomb is working on compiling records of septic service for each home to create an ongoing septic inspection and service program

Bath Water Brew Pub

By Liz Dane

Have you checked out the brewery and pub that opened over New Years? A new "neighborhood" brewpub just moved into the Coolfont area.



Karl Wagenbrenner and his wife, Denise, have been brewing beer in Berkeley Springs since 2015. They have spent the last year building their new location adjacent to CMA, at 110 Michigan Lane - across the street from the Coolfont Resort.

There are two parts to their new business:

The **Berkeley Springs Brewing Company** makes over 30 styles of beer, and they brew their own root beers and Kambucha. Karl is excited about this location as the water they use is excellent for brewing - it comes directly from the spring/well in the town of Bath.

The second part, **Bath Water Brewpub**, serves beer and wine and has a full bar. They have a 20-tap system, considered to be the largest tap system in Morgan County. Their food is entirely hand made in their kitchen. They try to avoid all processed foods and are using beer in almost all of their offerings.

The Brewpub is currently open Thursday through Monday - the hours vary by day. Once the new Coolfont Resort is opened, they'll be open every day.



Karl and Denise and are excited about getting to know the CMA residents and want to create a family atmosphere at their brewpub. This spring, they will be installing a barbecue smoker and will offer a full barbecue menu along with outdoor seating. They're available to host birthday parties and special occasions and will soon offer catering.

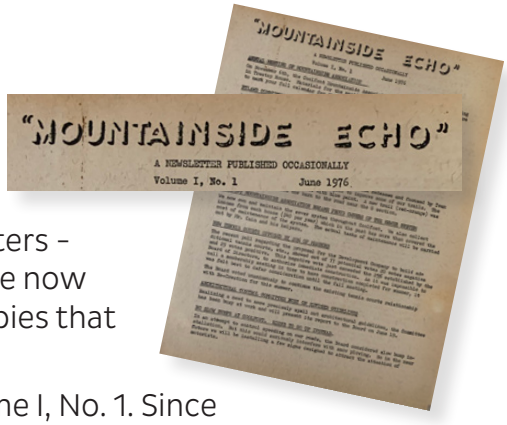


For more information and operating hours, visit www.berkeleyspringsbrewingcompany.com.

Bath Water Brewpub
Bring in a copy of this newsletter and receive half off the price of one of their appetizers!

Newsletter News

By Dawne Holz



In digging through the office archives, we found many old CMA newsletters - dating as far back as June 1976. All 95 of the back issues we could find are now posted on the CMA website for your reading pleasure. If you have old copies that we don't already have, please contact us at coolfont.news@gmail.com.



The June 1976 newsletter was noted as Volume I, No. 1. Since then, the newsletter name and volume numbers have varied: Mountainside Echo, The Mountainside, Mountaineer and The Mountainside News. Despite various names, it has been the source of news for CMA members for at least 43 years. As we start the new year, it seems appropriate that we properly note the volume number to reflect the longstanding history of providing news and information to CMA members. So, starting with this Winter 2019 issue - the first of 2019 - we note the new, updated information: Volume XLIV, Issue 1.

First Snow Fall of 2019







About 5" of snow fell overnight on January 12-13, blanketing the community in winter white. The cold temperatures kept much of it around until another storm arrived the next weekend, bringing another inch of snow, rain and brutal temperatures. By Martin Luther King, Jr. Day, everything was frozen solid. For a couple days, the community was more COLDfont than COOLfont. The snow plow contractor did a good job keeping the roads cleared. They were spotted on the roads several times during the weekends, plowing and treating community roadways.





Around 9:00 am on Sunday, January 20, high winds blew a tree down across Cold Run Valley Road, near the Coolfont Resort. It toppled a power pole with multiple lines and transformers, cutting off power to the community. Thanks to numerous reports by residents to Potomac Edison, they were onsite within an hour. They worked in the bitter cold to install a new pole and transformers and repair the lines - restoring power to nearly all residents, and the North Well, by 3:15 that afternoon.



Save the date! May 18!

Pool Clean Up Day!

Volunteers are needed to help with raking, weeding, pruning and mulching the grounds and cleaning and making minor repairs to equipment. We may include a pot luck lunch and perhaps a swim in the pool! Mark your calendar for the afternoon of May 18. All the details coming in the spring newsletter.





Spring will be here before the next newsletter! Bears will be waking up hungry and looking for food. Please secure your trash and bring your bird feeders in at night.

Photos: Terry Moore

Want to see your article or photo in the newsletter? Send them to coolfont.news@gmail.com



We Miss You, Stan

by Jackson Bain





In late October, our mountainside community lost a defining presence with the passing of Stan Bigelow. For those few who had not yet met Stan, he was a leader through the history of this village. Like most of us, he came to these woods to join with the energy of nature, and in doing so he brought with him peace and love and joy. He also brought his strong love of God, which informed everything he did with power, purpose and hope. We found those things as well, just by knowing him. Even being in the same room with Stan was a sharing of that energy, and a conversation with him was a full immersion in it. When there were difficult discussions among our members, he was the voice of reason who found the middle way that moved us all back together in our small but highly civil society.

He came here in 1979, living with his family in a trailer as he built his beautiful, artful and timeless home. Stop and listen for a moment as you walk on our lanes in the coming days. You will hear the wind in the branches, the leaves falling, the slight movement of our small animal neighbors – and Stan's spirit - timeless as his home and timeless as his love for Rosemary, his family and all of you. A memorial celebration of his life will be held at Coolfont on June 8.



Coolfont Mountainside Association

P.O. Box 418, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

Board of Directors

Jennifer Hughes, President
amica1234@yahoo.com
Sharon Geno, Vice President
Joan Claybrook, Secretary
Eileen Neely, Treasurer
Liz Dane, Director
Tom Holz, Director
Cindy Van Meter, Director

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coolfont.news@gmail.com

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www.coolfontmountainside.org
User ID: owner Password: coolfont

Listserv Email

cma-members@googlegroups.com

Listserv Signup/Web

groups.google.com/forum/#!forum/cma-members

Facebook

www.facebook.com/groups/257606361406

Committees & Contacts

Our committees are staffed primarily by volunteers from the community. They welcome any assistance with projects and events. If you would like to help, please contact the committee chair.

Site Managers - Holly Malcomb & Jason Schetrompf
304-671-0882 almostheavenpm1@gmail.com
304-676-3993

Communications/ListServ - Cindy Van Meter
703-532-6862 cndyvm@yahoo.com

DACC - Dennis Daisey
202-834-0180 dennis.daisey@gmail.com

Finance - Eileen Neely
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FireWise - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Infrastructure - Tom Holz
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Newsletter - Dawne Holz & Liz Dane
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301-509-5209

Nominations/Elections - Rusty McCrady
240-723-5930 rusty.mccrady@gmail.com

Recreation – Trails - Jason Geno
202-547-3304 jgeno@hciconsulting.net

Security/Neighborhood Watch - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

Social - Rosemary Bigelow
304-258-5352 rosemary@mygrandmotherslace.com

Technology – Website - Jeff Stovall
850-339-5279 jefferson.stovall@gmail.com

Water & Sewer – Liaison - Jackson Bain
703-894-8035 jackson@bainpr.com

Water System - Warm Springs Public Svc Dist
Mon - Fri, 9:00 am - 5:00 pm: 304-258-4118
All other times: Morgan County 304-258-0305

Sewer System - Position Vacant

Join the CMA Facebook group! Search Coolfont Mountainside Association in Facebook groups!

Our beautiful stand of red spruce trees (*Picea rubens*) near the meadow. Photo: Dawne Holz